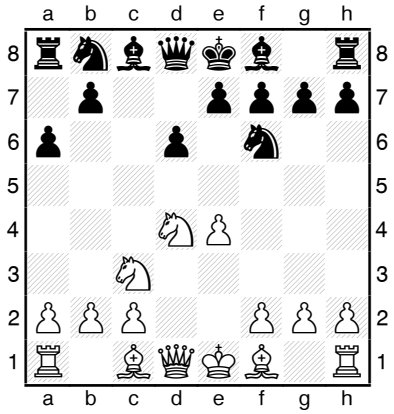
Najdorf [B90−B99]

Written by GM John Fedorowicz



The Najdorf is very popular in grandmaster chess. I have the greatest respect for this opening. Players who face the Najdorf very often shy away from the challenge and wind up in inferior positions.

At this time 6 ♗g5 which was considered to be White's main reply looks to have fallen out of favor. It has been replaced by 6 ♗e3. Kasparov favors the reply 6...♘g4 7 ♗g5 h6 8 ♗h4 g5 which has brought him good results. 6...e5 and 6...e6 are also battle tested.

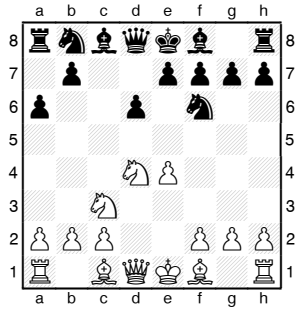
Of course we'll keep an eye out for White's other tries. 6 g3, 6 f4, 6 ♗c4 and 6 ♗e2 are all reasonable alternatives.

I particularly recommend that viewers check out Black's replies to the trendy 6 ♖g1. There are several decent ways of meeting this, I was very impressed by GM Topalov's treatment.

All the games given in blue can be accessed via ChessPub.exe, simply head for their respective ECO code.

Contents

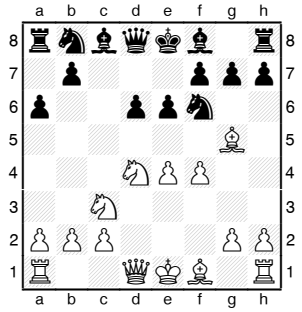
1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6



6 ♗g5

6 f3 e6 *(6...♕b6 7 ♘b3 e6* English Attack part 3 [B90]; *6...e5* English Attack part 4 [B90]*)* 7 ♗e3 English Attack part 5 [B90]
6 g3 e5 Najdorf with 6 g3 e5 [B91]
6 ♗e2 e5 Najdorf with 6 Be2 e5 [B92]
6 ♗e3 ♘g4 *(6...e5* English Attack part 4 [B90]*)* 7 ♗g5 h6 8 ♗h4 g5 9 ♗g3 ♗g7 English Attack part 2 [B90]

6...e6 7 f4



7 ♕f3 6 Bg5 miscellaneous part 2 [B95]

7...♗e7

7...♘bd7 Najdorf 6 Bg5 miscellaneous [B96]
7...♕b6 Poisoned Pawn Najdorf [B97]

8 ♕f3 ♕c7 9 0-0-0

Najdorf − old main line with g4 [B99]

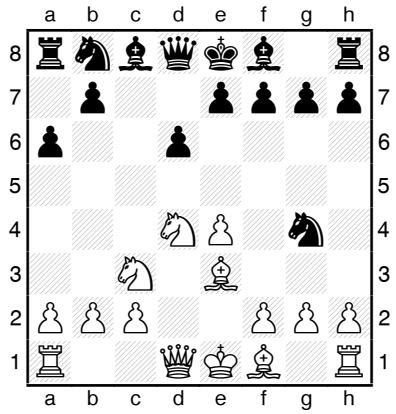
Press F5 to toggle the Navigation Pane, then click on the appropriate bookmark to go straight to that section.

Ctrl + 2 resizes the page.

English Attack part 2 [B90]

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1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗e3 ♘g4

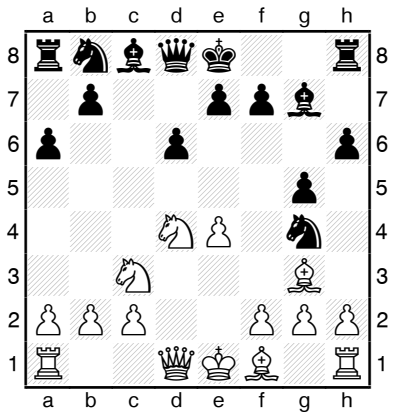


In recent times this move has proved to be inferior to 6...e5 and 6...e6.

7 ♗g5

7 ♗c1 ♘f6 8 ♗e3 ♘g4 9 ♗g5 h6 10 ♗h4 g5 11 ♗g3 ♗g7 12 ♗e2 *(12 h3 ♘f6 13 ♕d2 ♘c6 14 ♘b3 b5 15 a3 ♗e6 16 ♗e2 ♘d7 17 0-0 ♗xb3 18 cxb3 ♘d4 19 ♕d1 ♘c5 20 b4 ♘ce6 21 ♗g4 ♗e5 22 ♗xe6 ♘xe6 23 ♕d5 ♘f4 24 ♗xf4 gxf4 25 a4 0-0 26 axb5±* Kovacevic,A−De Firmian,N/Istanbul TUR 2000*.)* 12...h5 13 ♗xg4 hxg4 14 0-0 ♘c6 15 ♘f5 ♗xc3 16 bxc3 ♕a5 17 ♕xg4 f6 18 ♕f3 ♘e5 19 ♗xe5 ♕xe5 20 h3 d5 21 ♘g3 dxe4 22 ♕xe4 ♕xe4 23 ♘xe4 ♗f5 24 ♖fe1 ♔f7 25 ♖ab1 b5 26 c4 ♖h4 27 f3 ♗xe4 28 ♖xe4 ♖xe4 29 fxe4 ♔e6 30 cxb5 axb5 31 ♖xb5= Adams,M−Anand,V/Dortmund GER 1999

7...h6 8 ♗h4 g5 9 ♗g3 ♗g7



10 h3

In my opinion strongest. Black has been having a rough time vs 10 h3. 10 Be2 doesn't seem as good.

10 ♗e2 h5 *(10...♘e5 11 f3 ♘bc6 12 ♗f2 ♘g6 13 ♘d5 0-0 14 ♕d2 e6 15 ♘c3 ♗d7 16 g3 ♖c8 17 ♖d1 b5 18 ♘xc6 ♖xc6 19 ♗d4 e5 20 ♗e3 ♕c8 21 ♖c1 ♗e6 22 0-0 f5 23 exf5 ♗xf5 24 ♗d3 ♘e7 25 ♘d5 ♘xd5 26 ♗xf5 ♖xf5 27 ♕xd5+=* Cioara,A−Artizzu,G/Castellaneta ITA 1999*)* 11 ♗xg4 *(11 ♘f5 ♗xf5 12 exf5 h4 13 ♗xh4 ♗xc3+ 14 bxc3 ♕a5 15 ♗xg5 ♘xh2 16 ♔d2 ♘d7 17 ♔c1 ♕xc3 18 ♖b1 ♘c5 19 ♕d5 ♖c8 20 ♗d2 ♕g7 21 ♗e3 ♖h7 22 g3 b5 23 ♕d4 ♕g8 24 f6 ♕g6 25 ♖b2 ♘f3 26 ♗xf3 ♖xh1+ 27 ♗xh1 ♘d3+ 28 ♔d2 ♘xb2 29 ♕xb2+−* Shirov,A−Polgar,J/Prague CZE 1999 *11 h4 gxh4 12 ♗xh4 ♘c6 13 ♘b3 ♗e6 14 ♕d2 ♕b6 15 ♘d5 ♗xd5 16 exd5 ♘ce5 17 ♕a5 ♕xa5+ 18 ♘xa5 ♘g6 19 c3 ♘f4 20 ♗g5 ♘xd5 21 ♗f3 ♘c7 22 ♗xb7 ♖b8 23 f3 ♘e5 24 0-0-0 ♔f8 25 ♖h4=* Santo Roman,M−Miralles,G/Cannes FRA 2000*.)*

a) 11...♗xg4 12 f3 ♗d7 *(12...♗e6 13 ♗f2 ♘d7 14 ♕d2 ♘e5 15 b3 ♕a5 16 ♘d5 ♕xd2+ 17 ♔xd2 ♖c8 18 ♘b6 ♖c7 19 c4 ♘c6 20 ♔d3 ♘xd4 21 ♗xd4 ♗xd4 22 ♔xd4=* Madl,I−Roschina,T/Pula CRO 1999*)* 13 ♗f2 ♘c6 14 0-0 *(14 ♕d2 ♕a5 15 0-0 ♘xd4 16 ♗xd4 ♗e5 17 ♗xe5 ♕xe5 18 ♘d5 ♖c8 19 c3 f6 20 ♖ad1 ♔f7 21 ♕f2 ♖hd8 22 ♘b6 ♖c6 23 ♖d5 ♕e6 24 h4 g4 25 ♖xh5+−* Medvegy,Z−Szeberenyi,A/Budapest HUN 2000 *14 ♘d5 ♖c8 15 ♕d2 e6 16 ♘xc6 ♖xc6 17 ♘b4 ♖c4 18 c3 ♕a5 19 0-0 ♗e5 20 ♖fd1 ♗a4 21 ♖e1 ♗d7 22 ♖ad1 h4 23 ♘d3 ♖g8 24 ♘xe5 ♕xe5 25 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 26 ♖xd6=* Barlov,D−Suarez Roa,J/Cala Galdana ESP 1999*.)* 14...e6 15 ♘de2 ♕e7 16 ♘a4 ♘e5 17 ♘b6 ♖d8 18 ♗d4 ♗c6 19 c4 ♖g8 20 ♘c3 ♕f6 21 ♔h1 ♕h6 22 ♕e2 h4 23 h3 ♘g6 24 ♗xg7 ♕xg7 25 ♕e3 ♕e5 26 ♖fe1 ♘f4 27 ♖ad1 f5 28 ♕d4 ♕xd4 29 ♖xd4 fxe4 30 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 31 ♖dxe4 ♔f7 32 ♖d4 d5 33 cxd5 exd5 34 ♖ed1= Pelletier,Y−Kempinski,R/Batumi GEO 1999

b) 11...hxg4

b1) 12 0-0 ♘c6 13 ♘f5 ♗xc3 *(13...♗xf5 14 exf5 ♗xc3 15 bxc3 ♘e5 16 ♖b1 ♕c7 17 ♗xe5 dxe5 18 ♕d5 ♖b8 19 ♖fe1 f6 20 ♖ed1 ♕c8 21 ♕e4 ♕xc3 22 ♖b3 ♕c5 23 g3 ♔f7∓* Sulc,D−Zivkovic,V/Pula CRO 1999*)* 14 bxc3 ♕a5 15 ♕xg4 f6

b1a) 16 f4 ♗xf5 17 exf5 gxf4 18 ♖xf4 *(18 ♕xf4 ♕xc3 19 ♖ae1 0-0-0 20 ♖e4 ♖d7 21 ♖c4 ♕a5 22 a4 ♔b8 23 ♖b1 ♖c7 24 ♕e3 ♕d5 25 ♖e4 ♕xf5 26 ♗f2 ♔c8 27 h3 ♖g8∓* Klovans,J−De Firmian,N/Hamburg GER 1999*)* 18...♕xc3 19 ♖b1 b5 20 ♕e2 *(20 a4 ♕xc2 21 ♖ff1 ♕c4 22 ♖f4 ♕c2 23 ♖ff1 ♕xa4 24 ♕g7 ♔d7 25 ♖fd1 ♖ag8 26 ♕f7 ♖xg3 27 ♕e6+ ♔c7 28 hxg3 ♕c4=*

Ng Tze Han2−Wong Zi Jing/Penang MYA 2000*)* 20...♖c8 21 a4 ♘d4 22 ♕g4 ♕e3+ 23 ♔f1 ♘xc2 24 ♖e4 ♕d3+ 25 ♔g1 ♘e3 26 ♖xe7+ ♔d8 27 ♕e4 ♕xe4 28 ♖xe4 ♘xf5 29 axb5= Kobalija,M−De Firmian,N/Las Vegas USA 1999

b1b) 16 ♖ab1 ♕xc3 17 ♖fd1 ♘e5 18 ♗xe5 ♕xe5 19 g3 b5 20 c4 bxc4 21 ♕f3 c3 22 ♖bc1 ♗b7 23 ♕xc3 ♗xe4 24 ♘xd6+ exd6 25 ♖e1 ♕xc3 26 ♖xc3 d5 27 f3 ♔f7 28 fxe4 ♖he8= Shirov,A−Kasparov,G/Sarajevo 1999

b1c) 16 ♕f3 16...♘e5 17 ♕e3 ♗xf5 18 exf5 ♖c8 19 ♕a7 ♔f7 20 ♕xb7 ♖xc3 21 ♖fd1 ♕b5 22 ♕a7 ♘c6 23 ♕d7 ♘d4 24 ♕xb5 ♘xb5 25 a4 ♘a7 26 ♖ab1 ♖hc8 27 h4 gxh4 28 ♗xh4 ♖xc2 29 ♖e1 ♖8c7= Leko,P−Lutz,C/Frankfurt GER 1999

b2) 12 ♘d5 12...♘c6 13 ♘f5 ♗xf5 14 exf5 ♗xb2 15 ♖b1 ♕a5+ 16 ♕d2 ♗d4 17 ♕xa5 ♘xa5 18 ♘c7+ *(18 0-0 ♔d7 19 ♖b4 ♗a7 20 ♖e1 ♖he8 21 ♖xg4 ♖ac8 22 ♖ge4 ♘c6 23 c3 f6 24 ♖e6 ♘e5 25 ♖b1 b5 26 ♖d1 ♖c4 27 h3 ♗c5 28 ♗xe5 fxe5 29 ♖g6 ♖f8 30 ♖xg5±* Polgar,J−Leitao,R/Buenos Aires ARG 2000*)* 18...♔d7 19 ♘xa8 ♖xa8 20 ♔d1 ♗c3 21 h4 gxh3 22 ♖xh3 ♖c8 23 f4 gxf4 24 ♗xf4 b5 25 ♖f3 ♖c4 26 ♗d2 ♗xd2 27 ♔xd2 ♖a4 28 ♖a1 f6 29 g3 ♘c4+ 30 ♔e2 d5 31 c3 ♔d6∓ Anand,V−Topalov,V/Dortmund GER 1999

10 h4 ♘e5 11 ♘f5 ♗xf5 12 exf5 ♕a5 13 ♕d5 ♘bc6 14 ♕xa5 ♘xa5 15 ♘d5 ♖c8 16 0-0-0 ♘d7 17 ♗e2 ♘c4 18 ♗xc4 ♖xc4 19 ♖he1 ♗e5 20 ♗xe5 ♘xe5 21 f6± Landa,K−Mareck,S/Deizisau GER 2001

10 ♕d2 ♘c6 11 ♘b3 ♘ge5

a) 12 f3 b5 13 ♗f2 ♖b8 14 ♘d4 b4! At the time this game was played b4! was a big novelty. 15 ♘d1?! *(15 ♘ce2!?)* 15...♘xd4 16 ♗xd4 d5! Black grabs the initiative in the center. 17 exd5 ♕xd5 18 c3 0-0 19 ♗e2 ♖d8 20 ♕e3 ♗b7 21 ♘f2 bxc3 22 ♗xc3 ♕e6 23 ♔f1 ♗d5 24 b3 ♖bc8∓ Ivanchuk,V−Kasparov,G/Linares 1999

b) 12 a4 12...♗e6 13 ♘d5 ♖c8 14 f3 ♘g6 15 ♖a2 ♘f4 16 c3 ♗e5 17 ♗f2 ♗xd5 18 exd5 ♘a5 19 ♘xa5 ♕xa5 20 c4 ♕c7 21 a5 ♗f6 22 h4 ♖g8 23 hxg5 hxg5 24 ♗b6 ♕d7 25 b3± Hossain,E−Browne,W/Stratton Mountain USA 2000

10...♘f6

10...♘e5

a) 11 ♘f5 ♗xf5 12 exf5 ♘bc6 *(12...♘bd7 13 ♘d5 ♖c8 14 c3 ♘f6 15 ♗e2 ♘xd5 16 ♕xd5 ♕d7 17 0-0 ♖c5 18 ♕e4 ♕c6 19 ♕c2 ♗f6 20 ♖ac1 ♘d7 21 a3±* Luther,T−Bouaziz,S/Cappelle La Grande FRA 2000 *12...♕a5 13 ♕d5 ♘bc6 14 ♕xa5 ♘xa5 15 ♘d5 ♖d8 16 0-0-0 ♖g8 17 ♗e2 ♘ac6 18 h4 e6 19 ♘e3 d5 20 hxg5 hxg5 21 fxe6 fxe6* White is a tad better so Black must hunker down. *22 ♘g4 ♘f7 23 ♗d3 ♘b4 24 ♗h7 ♖h8 25 ♗g6 ♔e7 26 c3±* Spasov,V−Kempinski,R/Leon ESP 2001*.)* 13 ♘d5 e6 14 fxe6 fxe6 15 ♘e3 ♕a5+ *(15...0-0 16 ♗e2 d5 17 0-0 ♘g6 18 c4 ♘d4 19 cxd5 exd5 20 ♗g4 ♘f4 21 ♗xf4 ♖xf4 22 ♕d3±* Shirov,A−Gelfand,B/Monaco MNC 2000, with good chances on the light squares.*)* 16 c3 d5 17 ♗e2 0-0 *(17...d4!?* This might be best here as after 18...0-0 White can take his time. *18 ♘c4 ♘xc4 19 ♗xc4 0-0 20 0-0 dxc3 21 bxc3 ♕xc3 22 ♖c1 ♕f6 23 ♕d7 ♘d8 24 ♗d6 ♕f7 25 ♕a4 ♕e8 26 ♕c2 ♖f6 27 ♗e5 ♖f8 28 ♗xg7 ♔xg7 29 ♕c3+±* Cheparinov,I−Ibarra Jerez,J/Oropesa del Mar ESP 2001*.)* 18 0-0 ♖ad8 19 ♕b3 b5 20 ♖ad1 ♕b6 21 ♖fe1 ♕c5 22 ♕c2 White has full control. 22...b4 23 cxb4 ♕xb4 24 ♗xa6 ♖a8 25 a3 ♕b6 26 ♗f1 ♘d4 27 ♕b1 ♘df3+ 28 gxf3 ♘xf3+ 29 ♔g2 ♘xe1+ 30 ♖xe1± Anand,V−Gelfand,B/Haifa ISR 2000

b) 11 ♗e2 ♘bc6 12 ♘f5 ♗xf5 13 exf5 ♘d7 14 ♕d2 ♕a5 15 ♘d5 ♕xd2+ 16 ♔xd2 ♖c8 17 c3 ♘c5 18 f3 ♗e5 19 ♗xe5 ♘xe5 20 ♖he1 ♘a4 21 ♔c2 ♖c6 22 f4 gxf4 23 ♘xf4 ♖g8 24 g4 ♖b6 25 b3 ♘c5 26 ♗f1± Zapata,A−Roehrich,S/Internet ICC 2000

c) 11 f3 11...♘bc6 12 ♗f2 ♗e6 13 ♕d2

c1) 13...♘xd4 14 ♗xd4 ♕a5 15 a3 ♖g8 *(15...♗f6 16 0-0-0 ♖c8 17 ♔b1 ♔f8 18 h4 ♖g8 19 hxg5 hxg5 20 ♕e3 ♘d7 21 g3 ♗xd4 22 ♖xd4* White gets a free shot at Black's K. *22...♕c5 23 f4 ♘f6 24 ♕d2 b5 25 ♗e2 ♖b8 26 f5 ♗c4 27 b4±* De Firmian,N−Ruck,R/Istanbul TUR 2000*)* 16 h4 ♖c8 17 hxg5 hxg5 18 0-0-0 ♘c4 19 ♗xc4 ♗xd4 20 ♕xd4 *(20 ♗b5+ axb5 21 ♕xd4 ♖c4 22 ♕d2 ♔d7 23 ♘a2 ♕xd2+ 24 ♖xd2±* Bologan,V−Xu Jun/Beijing CHN 2000 − White has the better structure and the better minor piece.*)* 20...♖xc4 21 ♕a7 ♕c7 22 ♔b1 ♖c5 23 ♘d5 ♗xd5 24 exd5 ♔f8= Kasparov,G−Polgar,J/Linares ESP 2001

c2) 13...♖c8 14 0-0-0 *(14 h4 gxh4 15 ♖xh4 h5 16 ♖h1 ♗h6 17 f4 ♗g4 18 ♘d5 ♘xd4 19 ♗xd4 ♖g8 20 ♗b6 ♕d7 21 ♗e3 ♘c4 22 ♗xc4 ♖xc4 23 ♘b6 ♕c6 24 ♘xc4 ♕xc4⇄* Bakre,T−Krush,I/St Petersburg RUS 2000*)* 14...♕a5 15 ♘b3 ♕c7 16 a3 ♗xb3 17 cxb3 ♘a5 18 ♕c2 ♘g6 19 ♔b1 b5 20 ♖c1 ♕b7 21 b4 ♘c4 22 ♗xc4 ♖xc4 23 ♕d2 0-0 24 ♘d5 ♖fc8 25 ♖xc4 ♖xc4 26 ♘e3 ♖c7 27 h4 e6 28 hxg5 hxg5 29 ♘g4 ♕c6 30 ♗d4± Topalov,V−Gelfand,B/Bugojno BIH 1999

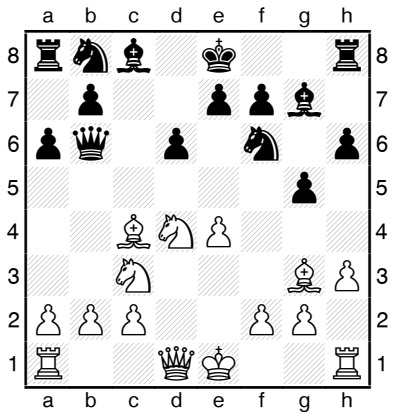
c3) 13...♕a5 14 ♘b3 ♗xb3 15 cxb3 ♘b4 16 a3 ♘g6 17 ♖d1 ♘c6 18 ♘d5 ♕xd2+ 19 ♖xd2 0-0 20 b4 b5 21 ♘c7 ♖ab8 22 ♘xa6 ♖b7 23 ♖d5 ♘a7 24 ♗xa7 ♖xa7 25 ♗xb5 ♗xb2 26 0-0 ♗xa3= Leko,P−Kasparov,G/Linares ESP 2000

11 ♗c4

11 ♕f3 ♕b6 *(11...♘c6 12 ♘xc6 bxc6 13 e5 dxe5 14 ♗xe5 0-0 15 ♗d3 ♕a5 16 ♕e2 ♗e6* White has the better king and structure. *17 0-0 c5 18 ♖fe1 ♖fd8 19 b3 ♘d7 20 ♗xg7 ♔xg7 21 ♘e4±* Ehlvest,J−De Firmian,N/Reykjavik ISL 2000*)* 12 0-0-0 ♘c6 13 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 14 e5 ♕xf3 15 gxf3 dxe5 16 ♗xe5 ♗d7 17 ♘d5 ♘xd5 18 ♗xg7 ♖h7 19 ♗e5 f6 20 ♖xd5 ♗c6 21 ♖d3= fxe5 22 h4 gxh4 23 ♖xh4 ♖d8 24 ♖e3 ♖d6 25 ♖xe5 ♖g7 26 ♗d3 ♖g2 27 ♖eh5 Shirov,A−Kasparov,G/Sarajevo BIH 2000

11 ♗e2 ♕b6 12 ♘b3 ♘c6 13 ♕d2 ♗d7 14 0-0 ♖c8 15 ♔h1 ♘e5 16 f4 ♘c4 17 ♗xc4 ♖xc4 18 e5 ♘e4 19 ♘xe4 ♖xe4 20 exd6 g4 21 ♖fe1 ♖xe1+ 22 ♖xe1± Jirovsky,P−Fajman,P/Ostrava CZE 2000

11...♕b6



11...♕a5 12 0-0 h5 Black's last 2 moves don't inspire confidence. 13 ♖e1 ♕c5 14 ♗b3 h4 15 ♗h2 g4 16 e5 g3 17 exf6 gxh2+ 18 ♔h1 ♗xf6 19 ♕f3 0-0 20 ♘de2 ♕f5 21 ♕xf5 ♗xf5 22 ♘d5 ♔g7 23 ♘xf6 ♔xf6 24 ♘c3 e6 25 ♘e4+ ♔e7 26 ♖ad1 ♖d8 27 ♘g5 ♘c6 28 ♘f3 ♖h8 29 ♔xh2± Kaufman,L−Donlag,D/Saint Paul USA 2000

12 0-0 0-0

This looks like a Classical Dragon where Black went nuts.
12...♘xe4? Not one of Shirov's better days! 13 ♘xe4 ♕xd4 14 ♘xd6+ exd6 15 ♕e2+ ♗e6 16 ♗xe6 0-0 17 ♖ad1 ♕f6 18 ♗d5± Ivanchuk,V−Shirov,A/Wijk aan Zee NED 2001

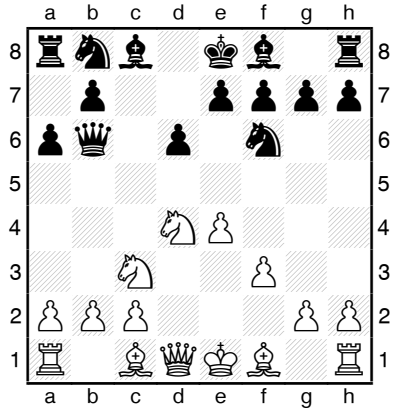
13 ♘de2 ♕xb2 14 ♗b3 ♕a3 15 f4 ♘c6 16 ♔h1 ♗e6 17 ♕d3 ♖ac8 18 fxg5 hxg5 19 ♘d5 ♖fe8 20 ♖ad1 ♘b4 21 ♕f3 ♘bxd5 22 exd5 ♗d7 23 c3 a5 24 ♕d3 a4 25 ♗c2 ♕c5 26 ♖xf6! exf6 27 ♕h7+ ♔f8 28 ♘d4 ♖e5 29 ♗xe5 fxe5 30 ♘e6+ ♗xe6 31 dxe6+−

Kasparov,G−Polgar,J/Wijk aan Zee NED 2000.

English Attack part 3 [B90]

Last updated: 06/04/02 by Fed

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 f3 ♕b6!?



Anytime Black can chase the knight from the center he should.

7 ♘b3 e6 8 ♕e2

8 g4

a) 8...♕c7 9 ♗e3 b5 10 ♕d2 ♘bd7 *(10...♗b7 11 0-0-0 ♘fd7 12 ♗d3 ♘e5 13 f4 ♘c4 14 ♗xc4 bxc4 15 ♘d4 ♘d7 16 ♖hf1 ♘c5 17 f5 e5 18 ♘de2 ♘xe4 19 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 20 f6 gxf6 21 ♘c3 ♗c6 22 ♖xf6± Aagaard,J−Hummel,P/Oakham ENG 2000)* 11 g5 ♘e5 12 0-0-0 ♘fd7 13 f4 ♘c4 14 ♗xc4 ♕xc4 15 ♕f2 a5 16 ♖d4 ♕c6 17 a4 b4 18 ♘b5 ♗e7?! *(18...♘c5!? 19 ♘xc5 dxc5 20 ♖d2 ♗a6⇄ was best)* 19 ♖hd1 0-0 20 ♔b1 ♗a6 21 ♘xa5 ♕b6 22 ♘c4 ♕b8 23 ♘bxd6± Grischuk,A−Polgar,J/Cannes FRA 2001

b) 8...♘fd7 9 ♕e2 ♗e7 10 h4 ♕c7 11 ♗g5!? If Black allows the trade then d6 becomes a concern. 11...f6 12 ♗e3 b5 13 ♕f2 ♘c5 14 0-0-0 ♘bd7 15 ♔b1 0-0 16 g5?! *(16 ♘e2!?)* 16...♘e5 17 g6 ♘xg6 18 ♖g1 ♖f7 19 h5 ♘e5 20 h6 g6 21 ♘xc5 dxc5 22 f4 ♘d7 23 f5 ♘f8 24 ♗h3 ♔h8 25 fxe6 ♗xe6 26 ♘d5± Motylev,A−Polgar,J/Ohrid MKD 2001

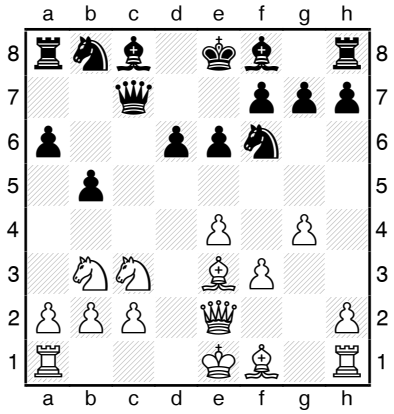
c) 8...♘c6 9 ♕e2 ♕c7 *(9...d5 10 ♗e3 d4 11 ♗f2 ♗c5 12 a3 ♕c7 13 0-0-0 ♗xa3 14 bxa3 dxc3 15 ♗c5 e5 16 ♕e3 ♘d4 17 g5 ♘h5 18 ♕xc3 ♘xb3+ 19 cxb3 ♗e6 20 ♔b2 ♖c8 21 ♗b4 ♕xc3+ 22 ♗xc3 f6 23 gxf6 gxf6 24 ♖d6± Grischuk,A−Shirov,A/Linares ESP 2001)* 10 ♗e3 b5 *(10...h6 11 0-0-0 b5 12 h4 ♗b7 13 ♖g1 ♘e5 14 g5 hxg5 15 hxg5 ♘fd7 16 f4 ♘c4 17 ♗d4 e5 18 ♘d5 ♗xd5 19 exd5 0-0-0 20 fxe5 dxe5 21 ♗f2* Black's king is feeling the draft. *21...f5 22 gxf6 gxf6 23 ♕f3±*

Grischuk,A–Krush,I/Torshavn FAI 2000*)* 11 0-0-0 ♗e7 *(11...♗b7 12 h4 ♖c8 13 ♔b1 ♘d7 14 ♖g1 ♘ce5 15 ♕f2 b4 16 ♘a4 ♘xf3?!* Winning a pawn, but getting the worse of matters. *17 ♕xf3 ♕c6 18 ♘ac5! ♘xc5 19 ♗xc5 dxc5 20 ♘a5 ♕c7 21 ♘xb7 ♕xb7 22 ♗c4±* Grischuk,A–Shirov,A/New Delhi IND 2000Black has zero activity.*)* 12 ♔b1 ♘d7 13 ♕f2 ♗b7 14 g5 ♖c8 15 ♖g1 0-0 16 h4 b4 17 ♘a4 ♘ce5 18 ♘b6 ♘xb6 19 ♗xb6 ♕b8 20 ♗h3 ♘c4 21 ♗a7 ♕c7 22 h5 White's king side is on the move while Black has trouble mustering anything. 22...a5 23 g6 ♗f6 24 ♗d4 e5 25 gxf7+ ♔xf7 26 ♗xc8 ♖xc8 27 ♗a7 a4 28 ♘c1 d5 29 ♘d3 d4 30 ♗c5 ♘e3 31 ♗xb4± Leko,P–Topalov,V/Batumi GEO 1999

8...♕c7 9 g4

9 ♗e3 b5 10 ♕f2 ♘bd7 11 0-0-0 b4 12 ♘e2 ♗b7 13 g4 ♖c8 14 ♘ed4 e5 15 ♘f5 g6 16 ♘g3 d5 17 g5 d4 18 ♗xd4 exd4 19 gxf6 ♗h6+ 20 ♔b1 ♗e3 21 ♕g2 ♘xf6 22 ♗d3 ♘d7 23 ♘e2 ♕b6 24 ♘exd4! ♗xd4 25 ♘xd4 ♕xd4 26 ♗b5 ♕xd1+ 27 ♖xd1 axb5 28 ♕d2 ♘c5 29 ♕d6 ♘e6 30 ♕d7+ ♔f8 31 ♕xb7+– De la Riva Aguado,O–Shirov,A/Andorra AND 2001.

9...b5 10 ♗e3



10 g5 ♘fd7 11 ♗e3 b4 12 ♘d1 ♘c6 13 ♘f2 a5 14 ♗g2?! This looks a little weird. 14...♗a6 15 ♘d3 a4 16 ♘d2 ♘ce5 17 f4 ♕xc2 18 ♘xb4 ♕xb2 19 ♘xa6 ♕xa1+∓ De la Riva Aguado,O–Shirov,A/Andorra AND 2001.

10 a3 ♘c6 11 ♗g2 ♗e7 12 f4 ♗b7 13 0-0 ♘d7 14 ♗e3 ♘b6 15 a4 ♘xa4 16 ♘xa4 bxa4 17 ♖xa4 0-0 18 g5 White's king is loose for nothing. 18...a5 19 f5 ♗a6 20 c4 ♖ab8∓ Sax,G–Odeev,H/Saint Vincent ITA 2000

10...b4 11 ♘a4 ♘bd7 12 ♕c4

12 ♕f2 ♖b8 13 g5 ♘h5 14 ♘d4 e5 15 ♘f5 g6 16 ♘g3 ♘f4 17 0-0-0 ♗e7 18 h4 0-0 19 b3 f6 20 ♗c4+ ♔h8 21 h5 fxg5 22 hxg6 ♘xg6 23 ♘f5 ♘f6 24 ♗xg5 ♗xf5 25 exf5 ♘f4 26 ♗xf4 exf4 27 ♗e6 d5 28 ♕d4± De la Riva Aguado,O–Shirov,A/Andorra AND 2001.

12...♕xc4 13 ♗xc4 d5 14 exd5 ♘e5 15 ♗e2 ♘xd5

Black's N's have jumped to life while White's N's are passive.

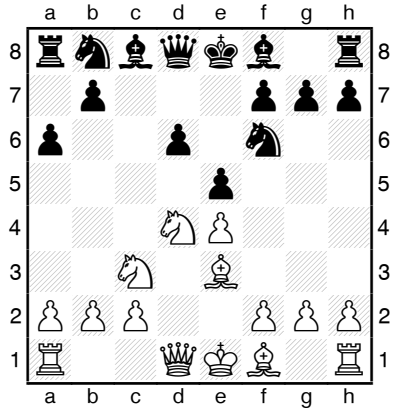
16 ♗d4 ♗d6 17 ♗c5 ♗e7 18 a3 a5 19 ♗d4 f6 20 ♘ac5 0-0 21 0-0 bxa3 22 ♖xa3 ♘f4 23 ♗b5 ♖b8 24 ♗xe5 ♘h3+ 25 ♔g2 ♖xb5 26 ♗g3 ♘g5 27 ♗f2 ♗b7 28 ♗g1 ♖c8 29 h4 ♗xf3+ 30 ♖xf3 ♘xf3 31 ♔xf3 ♗xc5 32 ♘xc5 ♖bxc5 33 ♗xc5 ♖xc5-+

Grischuk,A−Kasparov,G/Linares ESP 2001.

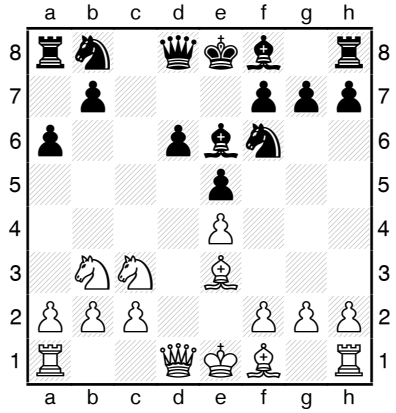
English Attack part 4 [B90]

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1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗e3 e5



7 ♘b3 ♗e6



7...♗e7 8 f3 ♗e6 9 g4?! d5! 10 exd5 ♘xd5 11 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 12 ♕e2 ♕c7 13 0-0-0 ♗e6 14 ♕f2 ♘d7 15 f4 ♗xg4 16 ♖d3 0-0 17 ♖g1 ♗f5 18 ♖c3 ♕d8 19 fxe5 ♗g6 20 ♗d4 ♗g5+ 21 ♔b1 ♖e8 22 e6 ♖xe6 23 ♗c4 ♖c6∓ Damaso,R−Dominguez,L/Lisbon POR 2000

8 ♕d2

8 f3 Normally transposes, but can be used to play a quick g4: 8...♘bd7 *(8...h5 9 ♘d5 ♗xd5 10 exd5 ♘bd7 11 c4 ♗e7 12 ♗e2 g6 13 0-0 ♔f8 14 ♕d2 ♔g7 15 ♘a5 ♕c8 16 b4 ♗d8 17 ♘b3 ♗b6 18 ♖ac1 ♗xe3+ 19 ♕xe3 b6 20 f4 exf4 21 ♕xf4 ♕e8 22 ♖ce1 ♕e5 23 ♕c1 ♕e7 24 ♘d4±* Vescovi,G−Leitao,R/Sao Paulo BRA 2000*)* 9 g4

a) 9...b5 10 g5 b4 11 ♘e2 *(11 ♘d5 ♘xd5 12 exd5 ♗f5 13 ♗d3 ♗xd3 14 ♕xd3 ♗e7 15 h4 0-0 16 0-0-0 a5 17 ♘d2 f5 18 gxf6 ♘xf6 19 h5 ♕c8 20 h6 g6 21 ♖hg1 ♔h8 22 f4 ♘g4 23 fxe5 ♘xe5 24 ♗d4!* Black is all tied up. *24...♗f6 25 ♕e3 ♕c7 26 ♘e4 ♖ac8 27 ♖g2 ♔g8 28 ♕h3 ♖ce8 29 ♖f2±* Shirov,A−Svidler,P/Wijk aan Zee 1999*)* 11...♘h5 12 ♕d2 ♗e7 13 ♘g3 ♘f4 14 h4 h6 15 ♗xf4 exf4 16 ♘h5 ♗xb3 17 axb3 g6 18 ♘xf4 hxg5 19 ♘d5 ♘e5 *(19...♖xh4 20 ♖xh4 gxh4 21 0-0-0 ♘f6 22 ♗c4 ♘xd5 23 ♕xd5* With a strong attack in the bishop of opposite middlegame. *23...♗g5+ 24 ♔b1 ♖a7 25 e5 ♔f8 26 e6 ♗f6 27 exf7+−* Adams,M−Svidler,P/Dos Hermanas 1999*)* 20 ♗e2 g4 21 f4 ♗xh4+ 22 ♔f1 ♘f3 23 ♕xb4 ♗f6 24 ♗xf3 gxf3 25 ♔f2 a5 26 ♕b7 0-0 27 ♔xf3 ♔g7 28 f5 ♖b8 29 ♕a7 ♖a8 30 ♕e3 ♖h8 31 ♔g2 ♖h5∞ Fedorov,A−Topalov,V/Batumi GEO 1999

b) 9...h6 10 ♕d2 b5 11 0-0-0 ♘b6 12 ♕f2 ♘fd7 13 ♔b1 ♗e7 14 h4 ♕c7 15 ♘d5 ♗xd5 16 exd5 ♖b8 17 f4 ♘f6 18 ♕g2 h5 19 gxh5 ♘xh5 20 fxe5 dxe5 21 ♘a5± Kobalija,M−Gadjily,R/Batumi GEO 1999, Black has no chances for king safety.

c) 9...♘b6 10 ♕d2 d5 11 0-0-0 d4 12 ♘xd4 exd4 13 ♗xd4 ♗e7 14 ♕e3 ♘bd7 15 h3 White has 2 pawns for the piece and serious attacking chances. 15...♕a5 16 f4 ♗xa2 17 g5 ♘h5 18 h4 ♖g8 19 ♗h3 ♘c5 20 ♗g4 g6 21 ♘xa2 ♕xa2 22 ♗xc5 ♕a1+ 23 ♔d2 ♖d8+ 24 ♔e2 ♕xb2 25 ♔f3 ♕xc2 26 ♖xd8+ ♗xd8 27 ♖c1± Topalov,V−Ivanchuk,V/Monaco MNC 2000

8...♗e7

8...♘bd7 9 f3

a) 9...h5

a1) 10 ♗e2 ♗e7 11 ♘d5 ♘xd5 12 exd5 ♗f5

a1a) 13 ♘a5 ♕c7 14 c4 0-0 15 0-0 ♗f6 16 ♖ac1 b6 17 ♘c6 ♘b8 18 ♘xb8 *(18 ♘b4!?)* 18...♖axb8 19 b4 ♕d7 20 c5 bxc5 21 bxc5 dxc5 22 ♖xc5 ♗e7 23 ♖c6 ♗b4= David,A−Dinstuhl,V/Castrop−Rauxel GER 2000

a1b) 13 0-0 13...♕c7 *(13...a5 14 f4!* The Bf5 becomes vulnerable in these situations. *14...a4 15 fxe5 axb3 16 ♖xf5 bxa2 17 e6 ♘f6 18 exf7+ ♔xf7 19 ♗d4 ♕c8 20 ♗d3 ♖f8 21 ♕e2 ♖h8 22 b3 ♕d7 23 c3+−* Galliamova,A−Hunt,H/Istanbul TUR 2000*)* 14 c4 b6 15 f4 g6 16 fxe5 *(16 ♖ad1 a5 17 fxe5 ♘xe5 18 ♖xf5 gxf5 19 ♘d4 ♘g4 20 ♘c6 ♖g8 21 ♖f1 ♘e5 22 ♖xf5±* Topalov,V−Zhang Zhong/Moscow RUS 2001*)* 16...dxe5 17 ♘c1 a5 18 a3 ♘c5 19 b3 h4 20 ♖a2 0-0 21 ♕e1 ♔g7 22 b4 axb4 23 axb4 ♖xa2 24 ♘xa2 ♘d3 25 ♕c3 ♖a8 26 ♗xd3 ♗xd3 27 ♕xd3 ♖xa2 28 c5 bxc5 29 ♕c4 ♕a7 30 ♗xc5 ♗xc5+ 31 bxc5± Ponomariov,R−Cvitan,O/Neum BIH 2000

a2) 10 a4 10...♘b6 *(10...♗e7 11 ♗e2 ♖c8 12 0-0 ♘b6 13 ♖fd1 d5 14 a5 d4 15 axb6 ♗xb3 16 cxb3 dxe3 17 ♕xd8+ ♗xd8 18 ♖a5 ♘d7 19 ♖ad5 ♘xb6 20 ♖xe5+ ♔f8 21 ♖c5 ♔e8 22 ♖xc8 ♘xc8 23 ♘d5 ♘e7 24 ♘xe3 ♗b6 25 ♖d3 ♘g6 26 ♔f1 ♘f4 27 ♖c3 ♘xe2 28 ♔xe2 ♔d7 29 ♖d3+ ♔c6 30 ♘f5±* Polgar,J−Sadvakasov,D/Hoogeveen NED 1999*)* 11 a5 ♘c4 12 ♗xc4 ♗xc4 13 ♘a4 ♖b8 14 ♘b6 ♗e6 15 0-0-0 ♗e7 16 ♕c3 ♘d7 17 ♘c5 ♘xc5 18 ♗xc5 ♕c7 19 ♗b4 ♕xc3 20 bxc3 ♖d8 21 ♖d3 ♖h6 22 ♖hd1 ♖g6 23 g3 ♖f6 24 h3 ♗xh3 25 ♖h1 ♗e6 26 ♖xh5 ♖h6 27 ♖xh6 gxh6 28 g4± Shirov,A−Polgar,J/Prague CZE 1999

b) 9...b5 10 a4! This leads to the win of a pawn, but at a cost in development, *(10 g4 ♘b6 11 g5 ♘fd7 12 ♘d5 ♖c8 13 ♘xb6 ♘xb6 14 ♕a5 ♘c4 15 ♗xc4 bxc4 16 ♕xd8+ ♔xd8 17 ♘a5 h6 18 gxh6 g6 19 0-0-0 ♔c7 20 b3 ♗xh6 21 ♗xh6 ♖xh6 22 bxc4 g5 23 ♖hg1 ♔b6 24 ♘b3 ♗xc4 25 ♖d2 ♖g6 26 ♔b2 ♔c7 27 ♖dg2 ♖h6∓* Adams,M−Kasparov,G/Internet 2000*)* 10...b4 *(10...bxa4 11 ♖xa4 ♕c8 12 ♗e2 ♗e7 13 0-0 0-0 14 ♖fa1 ♘b8 15 ♘d5 ♘xd5 16 exd5 ♗d7 17 ♖b4 ♗d8 18 ♘a5 ♗f5 19 ♘c4 ♗c7 20 ♘b6 ♗xb6 21 ♖xb6 ♕c7 22 c4 ♗c8 23 ♕a5 f5 24 b4 f4 25 ♗f2 ♗b7 26 c5±* Nijboer,F−Vink,N/Wijk aan Zee NED 2001*)* 11 ♘d5 ♗xd5 12 exd5 ♘b6 13 ♗xb6 ♕xb6 14 a5 ♕b7 15 ♗c4 g6 *(15...♗e7 16 ♖a4 ♖b8 17 ♘c1 ♗d8 18 b3 e4 19 ♘a2 exf3 20 gxf3 ♘d7 21 ♕e3+ ♔f8 22 ♔d1 ♘e5 23 ♖e1 g5∞* Nijboer,F−Van Blitterswijk,S/Leeuwarden NED 2000*)* 16 ♖a4 ♖b8 17 ♘c1 h5 18 ♘d3 ♗h6 19 ♕xb4 ♕c7 20 ♕a3 0-0 21 ♘f2 ♗c1 22 ♘d3 ♗e3 23 ♔d1 ♖fc8 24 ♖e1 ♗h6 25 c3 ♖b5 26 ♗xb5 axb5 27 ♖b4 ♘xd5 28 ♖xb5 ♕c4 29 ♖xd5 ♕xd5 30 ♔c2 ♖a8 31 a6± Polgar,J−Shirov,A/Linares ESP 2001

9 f3 0-0

9...h5

a) 10 0-0-0 ♘bd7 11 ♔b1 ♖c8

a1) 12 ♘d5 ♘xd5 *(12...♗xd5 13 exd5 ♘b6 14 ♗xb6 ♕xb6 15 ♗d3 g6 16 ♖he1 ♘d7 17 g3 ♔d8 18 ♖e4 ♘c5 19 ♖b4±* Timman,J−De Firmian,N/Malmo 1999*)* 13 exd5 ♗f5 14 ♗d3 ♗xd3 15 ♕xd3 ♗g5 16 ♗f2 0-0 17 h4 ♗h6 18 g4 ♗f4 19 ♘d2 hxg4 20 fxg4 ♖e8 21 g5 *(21 ♘e4!?)* 21...e4 22 ♘xe4 ♘e5 23 ♕h3 ♘c4 24 ♖he1 b5 25 ♗d4 ♗e5 26 ♗xe5 ♖xe5 27 h5 ♕c7 28 ♕h2 ♕e7 29 h6 ♖xe4 30 hxg7± Perunovic,M−Sadvakasov,D/Subotica YUG 2000

a2) 12 ♗d3 12...♘c5 13 ♗e2 ♘xb3 14 cxb3! Recapturing this way makes it harder for Black to attack. 14...b5 15 h4 0-0 16 ♗g5 b4 17 ♘a4 a5 18 ♕e3 ♖b8 19 g3 ♘h7 20 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 21 g4 ♘f6 22 ♖hg1 hxg4 23 fxg4 d5 24 exd5 ♘xd5 25 ♕xe5 ♖bd8 26 ♗d3 ♕a7 27 ♕e4 ♘f6 28 ♕f3 ♗d5 29 ♕f5 ♗e6 30 ♕c5 ♕xc5 31 ♘xc5± Tiviakov,S−Gallagher,J/Batumi GEO 1999

b) 10 ♘d5 10...♘xd5 *(10...♗xd5 11 exd5 ♘bd7 12 ♗e2 g6 13 ♘a5 ♕c7 14 c4 ♔f8 15 0-0 ♔g7 16 b4 ♘e8 17 ♖ac1 f5* Black has no attacking chances on the k−side while White is close to opening up the q−side. *18 f4 ♘ef6 19 fxe5 ♘xe5 20 ♘b3 ♘e4 21 ♕d1 ♗f6 22 ♘d4±* Popovic,P−Tadic,B/Herceg Novi YUG 2001*)* 11 exd5 ♗f5 12 ♗e2 *(12 c4 0-0 13 ♗e2 a5 14 0-0 a4 15 ♘c1 ♗g6 16 ♘d3 ♘d7 17 b4 f5 18 f4 b6 19 ♖ac1±* 1/2-1/2 Berkvens,J−Ashley,M/Wijk aan Zee NED 2000 Black's position looks disjointed.*)* 12...♕c7 13 ♖c1 a5 14 a4 ♘d7 15 ♗d3 ♗xd3 16 ♕xd3 0-0 17 ♕b5 ♗h4+ 18 g3 ♗e7 19 0-0 f5 20 f4 ♔h7 21 ♘d2 e4 22 ♘c4 ♗d8 23 ♔h1 ♖f7 24 c3 ♖c8 25 b3 g6= Timman,J−Topalov,V/Bugojno BIH 1999

9...♘bd7 10 g4 h6 *(10...0-0 11 g5 ♘h5 12 0-0-0 ♕c7 13 ♔b1 b5 14 ♘d5 ♗xd5 15 exd5 ♘b6 16 ♘a5 ♘xd5 17 ♕xd5 ♕xa5 18 c4 ♖ab8 19 ♗d3 g6 20 ♖he1 ♖fc8 21 cxb5 axb5∞* Calzetta,M−Peptan,C/ New Delhi IND 2000 White has the bishop pair and it's difficult for Black to attack, but a pawn is a pawn.*)* 11 0-0-0 *(11 h4 b5 12 ♖g1 b4 13 ♘a4 d5 14 g5 d4 15 ♗xd4 hxg5 16 hxg5 ♘g4 17 ♗e3 ♘xe3 18 ♕xe3∓* Luther,T−Wendt,R/Bayern Open 1999*)* 11...b5

a) 12 ♔b1 ♕c7?! *(12...♘b6!?)* 13 h4 b4 14 ♘d5 ♗xd5 15 exd5 ♘b6 16 ♕xb4 ♘fxd5 17 ♖xd5 ♘xd5 18 ♕e4 ♘xe3 19 ♕xa8+ ♗d8 20 ♗d3+− Adams,M−Votava,J/Germany Bundesliga 1999

b) 12 h4 12...♘b6 13 ♕f2 ♘c4 14 ♗xc4 bxc4 15 ♘c5! The point of Qd2 was to clear the d file for this move. 15...♕c7 16 g5 ♘h5 17 ♘5a4 ♖b8 18 ♘b6 ♘f4 19 gxh6 g6 20 ♘bd5 ♗xd5 21 ♘xd5 ♕b7 22 b3 ♘xd5 23 ♖xd5 0-0 24 ♔b1 ♕b4 25 ♗d2 c3 26 a3 ♕c4 27 ♔a2 ♕c6 28 ♗c1 ♖b5 29 ♖hd1± Solak,D−Tzolas,G/Chania GRE 1999

9...♘c6?! This leads to a loss of time. 10 ♘d5 ♗xd5 11 exd5 ♘b8 12 ♗e2 ♘bd7 13 0-0 0-0 14 c4 ♘e8 15 ♘a5 ♕c7 16 b4 f5 17 ♖ac1 ♘ef6 18 ♔h1± Khruschiov,A−Yakup,E/Litohoto GRE 1999 White has better chances on the q−side

10 0-0-0

10 g4 d5 *(10...a5 11 g5 ♘fd7 12 a4 ♘b6 13 ♘d5 ♘xd5 14 exd5 ♗f5 15 h4 ♘d7 16 ♗d3 ♗xd3 17 ♕xd3 ♕c7 18 ♘d2 ♖ac8 19 c4 f5 20 b3 b6 21 0-0-0 b5 22 axb5 a4 23 ♔b2 e4 24 fxe4 ♘e5 25 ♕c2 fxe4 26 ♕xe4 axb3∞ De Firmian,N−Fedorowicz,J/WWchessnet 25 min exibit. 2000)* 11 g5 ♘xe4?! *(11...d4! 12 gxf6 ♗xf6 13 ♗f2 ♗g5 14 ♕d3 dxc3 15 ♕xd8 ♖xd8 16 bxc3 ♗xb3 17 axb3 ♗d2+∓ Khalifman,A−Lautier,J/Moscow RUS 2001*/The Week in Chess 369*)* 12 ♘xe4 dxe4 13 fxe4 ♕xd2+ 14 ♗xd2 ♘c6 15 0-0-0 ♖ac8 16 ♖g1 ♘b4 17 ♗xb4 ♗xb4 18 ♖g3 ♗e7∓ Bjornsson,S−Desmarais,C/Budapest HUN 2001

10...♕c7

10...a5 11 ♗b5 ♘a6 *(11...♘bd7 12 ♕f2 ♘e8 13 g4 ♘c7 14 ♗a4 ♗c4! 15 ♗xd7 ♕xd7* Now Black has control on the q−side *16 ♗b6 ♘b5 17 ♘d5 ♗xd5 18 ♖xd5 a4 19 ♘c5 ♕c6 20 ♘d3 a3 21 b3 ♖a6 22 ♗e3 ♘c7∓ Toma,K−Tsai,C/Oropesa del Mar ESP 1999)* 12 ♕e2 *(12 ♔b1 ♘c7 13 ♕e2 ♕c8 14 ♘d2 d5 15 exd5 ♘fxd5 16 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 17 ♘c4 ♕c7 18 ♗f2 ♗f6 19 ♕e4 ♖fd8 20 ♘e3 ♘xe3 21 ♗xe3 g6 22 g4 ♖ac8∓ Makarov,M−Dvoirys,S/Moscow RUS 1999)* 12...♘c7 13 ♘c5 ♘xb5 14 ♕xb5 ♕c8 15 ♘xe6 fxe6 16 ♖d3 ♖a6 17 a4 ♖f7 18 ♖hd1 ♗f8 19 ♕b3 ♕e8 20 ♔b1 ♖c6 21 g4 ♖c8 22 ♗b6 ♘d7 23 ♗g1 ♘f6 24 ♖3d2± Lastin,A−Dvoirys,S/Moscow RUS 1999 With a nice grip on the q−side.

11 g4 ♖c8 12 ♔b1 ♘bd7 13 ♕f2

13 g5 ♘h5 14 ♘d5 ♗xd5 15 exd5 ♘b6 16 ♖g1 a5 17 a3 a4 18 ♘c5! dxc5 19 d6 ♗xd6 20 ♕xd6 ♘f4 21 ♗xf4 exf4 22 ♗b5± Shirov,A−Gelfand,B/New Delhi IND 2000

13...b5 14 g5 ♘h5 15 h4 b4

15...♖cb8 16 ♘d5 ♗xd5 17 exd5 a5 18 ♗d3 a4 19 ♘c1 a3 20 c3 axb2 21 ♕xb2 White did nothing to slow Black down. 21...g6 22 ♗e4 ♖a4 23 ♘d3 ♘g3 24 ♘b4 ♘c5 25 ♗xc5 ♕xc5 26 ♖he1 ♗f8∓ Dworakowska,J−Gallagher,J/Calcutta IND 2001

16 ♘d5 ♗xd5 17 ♖xd5 a5 18 ♗h3 a4 19 ♘c1 ♖cb8 20 ♗g4 ♘f4 21 ♗xf4 exf4 22 ♗xd7 ♕xd7 23 ♕d2

Black has a lot of weak pawns and inferior minor piece.

23...♖b5 24 ♘e2 ♖c8 25 ♘xf4 b3 26 cxb3 axb3 27 a3 ♖c2 28 ♕d3 ♖b8 29 ♖d4 ♗f8 30 ♘d5 ♖f2 31 ♕e3 ♖g2 32 ♖d2+−

Anand,V−Van Wely,L/Wijk aan Zee NED 2001.

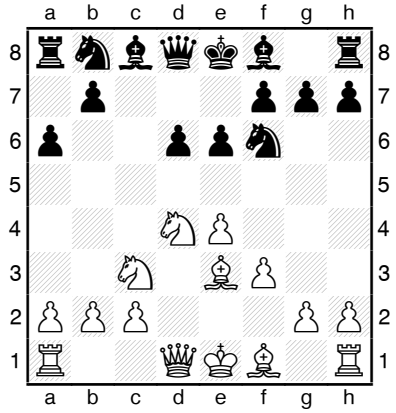
English Attack part 5 [B90]

Last updated: 06/04/02 by Fed

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 f3 e6

This move leads to positions more fluid than after 6...e5.

7 ♗e3



7...b5

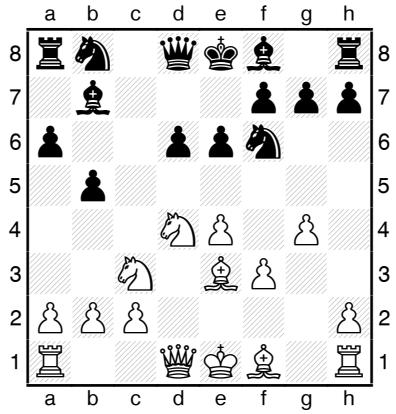
7...♗e7 8 ♕d2 0-0 9 0-0-0 ♘c6 This looks too slow. White's attack is more dangerous than anything Black can do. 10 g4 ♘d7 11 h4 ♘de5 12 ♕g2 b5 13 ♘xc6 ♘xc6 14 g5 ♕a5 15 ♔b1 b4 16 ♘e2 e5 17 f4 f5 18 gxf6 ♗xf6 19 f5 ♕c7 20 ♘g3 ♘d4 21 ♘h5 ♗b7 22 ♘xf6+ ♖xf6 23 ♗xd4 exd4 24 ♖xd4± Morozevich,A−Short,N/Sarajevo 1999.

8 g4

8 ♕d2 ♘bd7 9 g4 ♘b6 10 a4 *(10 g5 ♘fd7 11 0-0-0 ♗b7 12 ♗d3 ♘e5 13 ♔b1 ♘bc4 14 ♕e2 ♘xe3 15 ♕xe3* White loses the bishop pair for nothing. *15...b4 16 ♘ce2 ♕b6 17 f4 ♘d7 18 ♕h3 g6 19 ♖hf1 ♗g7 20 ♘xe6 fxe6 21 ♕xe6+ ♔d8 22 ♕f7 ♗f8*∓ Matthews,S−Arencibia,W/Istanbul TUR 2000*)* 10...♘c4 *(10...bxa4 11 ♘xa4 ♘xa4 12 ♖xa4 ♘d7 13 ♕a5 ♕xa5+ 14 ♖xa5 d5 15 ♔f2 dxe4 16 fxe4 ♗b7 17 ♗d3 ♗b4 18 ♖a4 ♗d6 19 ♘b3 ♘e5 20 h3 ♗c6 21 ♖a2 ♘xd3+ 22 cxd3 0-0*∓ Guid,M−Podkriznik,G/Bled SLO 2000*)* 11 ♗xc4 bxc4 12 0-0 ♗b7 13 g5 ♘d7 14 f4? This is too loosening. White had to stand pat. 14...♘c5 15 ♕g2 g6 16 ♖ad1 ♕c7

17 ♕g4 h6 18 f5 gxf5 19 exf5 e5 20 ♘e6 fxe6 21 ♕h5+ ♔d8 22 f6 ♕c6 23 ♖d2 ♔c7 24 g6 ♖g8 25 g7 ♗xg7-+ Anand,V−Kasparov,G/Kopavogur ISL 2000

8...♗b7



8...♘fd7!? 9 ♕d2 ♘b6 10 a4?! Black shouldn't have too many problems after this idea. 10...bxa4 11 ♘xa4 ♘xa4 12 ♖xa4 ♗e7 13 ♗e2 0-0 14 0-0 ♗b7 15 ♖fa1 ♘d7 16 ♘b3 ♖b8 17 ♗a7 ♖c8 18 ♘a5 ♗a8 19 ♗xa6 ♘e5 20 ♗e2 f5 21 gxf5 exf5 22 ♘c4 ♕e8 23 ♘xe5 dxe5 24 ♗d3 fxe4 25 fxe4 ♕h5 26 ♗e3 ♖c6 27 ♕e2 ♖g6+ 28 ♔h1 ♕xe2 29 ♗xe2 ♗c6 30 ♖c4 ♗b5∞ Anand,V−Kasparov,G/Kopavogur ISL 2000

9 ♕d2 ♘fd7 10 0-0-0 ♘b6 11 ♘b3!?

11 ♗d3 ♘8d7 12 ♔b1 ♖c8 13 g5 ♘e5 14 f4 ♘bc4 15 ♕e2 ♘xd3 16 cxd3 b4 17 ♘a4 ♕a5 18 dxc4 ♗xe4+ 19 ♘c2 ♕xa4-+ De la Riva Aguado,O−Simutowe,A/Istanbul TUR 2000.

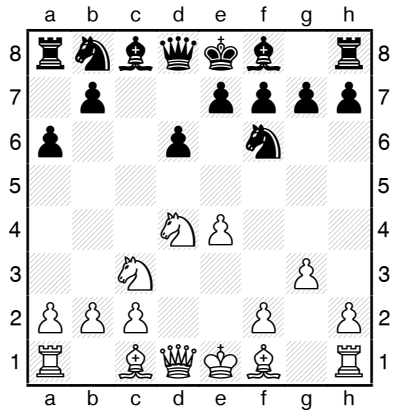
11...♘8d7 12 ♘a5 ♕c7 13 ♗f4 ♘c8 14 ♘e2 ♖b8 15 ♘xb7 ♖xb7 16 h4 ♗e7 17 ♗g5 ♘db6 18 ♘d4 0-0 19 ♔b1 ♖e8 20 ♗d3 ♗f8 21 ♕e2 ♘a4 22 ♗c1 ♘cb6 23 ♔a1 g6 24 h5±

Fedorov,A−Ermenkov,E/Ohrid MKD 2001.

Najdorf with 6 g3 e5 [B91]

Last updated: 06/04/02 by Fed

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 g3



This move is a good and safe way to get off the beaten track.

6...e5

This stays in the Najdorf, but I prefer 6...e6 transposing into a Scheveningen.

7 ♘de2 ♘bd7

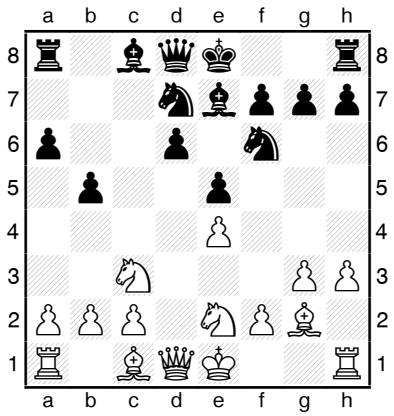
7...b5 8 ♗g2 ♗b7 9 h3 ♘bd7 10 g4 ♗e7 11 ♘g3 b4 12 ♘d5 ♘xd5 13 exd5 0-0 14 0-0 ♕b8 15 a3 *(15 ♘f5!?)* 15...a5 16 ♔h2 ♖c8 17 f4 ♕c7 18 ♘f5 ♗f8 19 ♖f2 g6 20 ♘g3 ♘c5 21 ♗e3 exf4 22 ♗xf4 ♗g7 23 axb4 axb4 24 ♖xa8 ♖xa8 25 b3= Movsesian,S−Svidler,P/Shenyang CHN 2000

8 ♗g2

8 a4 b6 9 ♗g2 ♗b7 10 0-0 h6 11 ♘d5 *(11 h3* with the idea of g4 and Ng3 is another try*)* 11...♘xd5 12 exd5 ♗e7 13 c4 0-0 14 a5 bxa5 15 ♗d2 ♕c8 16 b3 ♗d8 17 ♗h3 f5 18 ♕b1 ♘c5 19 ♗xa5 ♗xa5 20 ♖xa5 ♘e4 21 ♕xe4 ♕d8 22 ♗xf5 ♕xa5 23 ♗e6+ ♔h8 24 f4!⩱ ♕b6+ 25 ♔g2 ♖ae8 26 f5± Burnett,R−Breier,A/Groningen NED 1999

8 ♗g5!? Fighting for d5 makes sense.

8...♗e7 9 h3 b5



10 ♗e3 ♗b7 11 g4 b4 12 ♘d5 ♘xd5 13 exd5 0-0 14 ♕d2

14 ♘g3!?

14...a5 15 a3?!

White weakens his q−side for nothing.

15...♕c7 16 axb4 axb4 17 0-0 ♗a6 18 ♖fe1 ♖fb8 19 ♖a4 ♗xe2 20 ♖xa8 ♖xa8 21 ♖xe2 ♕b7 22 f4 exf4 23 ♗xf4 ♗f6 24 ♔h2 ♕b6 25 ♖e4 ♖b8 26 ♕e3 ♕xe3 27 ♖xe3 ♗e5 28 ♗xe5 ♘xe5∓

Blanco,C−Ashley,M/Philadelphia USA 2001 That's a good knight.

Najdorf with 6 Be2 e5 [B92]

Last updated: 06/04/02 by Fed

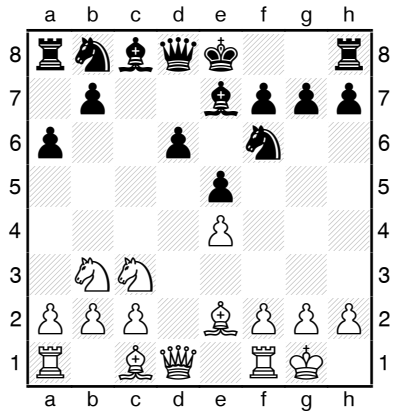
1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗e2

This is one of the quieter lines vs the Najdorf.

6...e5

White must be prepared for 6...e6 as well transposing into the Scheveningen.6...e5 creates a big fight over the d5 square.

7 ♘b3 ♗e7 8 0-0



8 ♗e3

a) 8...♗e6 9 ♘d5 *(9 f4 exf4 10 ♗xf4 ♘c6 11 ♕d2 0-0 12 0-0-0 ♘e8 13 ♘d5 ♗xd5 14 exd5 ♘e5 15 ♔b1 ♗f6 16 g4 ♘g6 17 ♗g3 ♗e5 18 g5 a5 19 a4 ♘c7 20 ♘xa5 ♕d7 21 b3 b5 22 ♗xe5 ♘xe5* Black's king is safer and he has some attacking chances. *23 axb5 ♘xb5 24 ♔b2 ♘d4⩲* De Firmian,N−Froehlich,P/Hamburg GER 1999*)*

a1) 9...♘xd5 10 exd5 ♗f5 11 ♕d2 ♘d7 12 ♘a5 ♕c7 13 c4 e4?! Handing White the d4 square without a fight. *(13...0-0* is normal, then White plays for f4*)* 14 ♗d4 ♗f6 15 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 16 0-0 0-0 17 b4 b6 18 ♘c6± Milos,G−Limp,E/Santos BRA 2001

a2) 9...♘bd7 10 ♕d3 ♗xd5 11 exd5 ♖c8 *(11...0-0 12 g4 ♘c5 13 ♘xc5 dxc5 14 0-0-0 e4 15 ♕d2 ♗d6 16 g5 ♘d7 17 h4 ♘e5 18 h5 ♖c8 19 ♖h4 c4 20 ♖xe4 c3 21 bxc3 ♕a5 22 ♔b1 ♖xc3 23 ♗d4 ♖fc8 24 ♗xc3 ♖xc3 25 ♕d4±* Khalifman,A−Gelfand,B/Las Vegas USA 1999*)* 12 c4 0-0 13 0-0 a5 14 ♖ad1 b6 15 ♘d2 ♘c5 16 ♕c2 ♘fd7 17 f3 ♗g5 18 ♗f2 f5 19 ♔h1 ♕f6 20 ♘b1

♕h6 21 ♘c3 ♖ce8 22 a3 e4 23 b4± Shirov,A−Polgar,J/ Linares ESP 2001 White's Nc3 becomes a real pain with Nb5 to c7 looming.

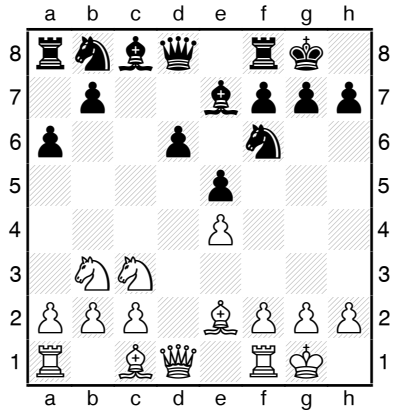
b) 8...0-0 9 g4 ♗e6 10 g5 ♘fd7 *(10...♘e8 11 ♕d2 ♘d7 12 f4 g6 13 0-0-0 ♘g7 14 h4 ♖c8 15 ♔b1 f5 16 h5±* Dolmatov,S−Zakharov,A/Linares ESP 2000 GM Dolmatov plays these positions very well.*)* 11 ♕d2 *(11 h4 ♘b6 12 f4 exf4 13 ♗xf4 ♘c6 14 ♘d5 ♗xd5 15 exd5 ♘e5 16 ♕d4 ♖c8 17 0-0-0 ♘bc4 18 ♘d2 b5 19 ♘xc4 ♘xc4 20 ♗d3 ♖e8 21 ♔b1 ♘e5 22 ♗xe5 dxe5 23 ♕g4 e4 24 ♗xe4 ♖c4 25 ♕g2±* Dolmatov,S−Ye Jiangchuan/Shenyang CHN 1999*)* 11...♘b6 *(11...a5 12 a4 ♘c6 13 f4 f5 14 exf5 ♗xf5 15 fxe5 dxe5 16 0-0-0 ♘b4 17 ♖hf1 ♗e6 18 ♖xf8+ ♕xf8=* Khalifman,A−Gelfand,B/Las Vegas USA 1999*)* 12 0-0-0 ♘8d7 13 h4 *(13 ♔b1 ♖c8 14 h4 ♘c4 15 ♗xc4 ♖xc4 16 f3 f5 17 exf5 ♖xf5 18 ♘d5 ♗f8 19 ♕d3 b5 20 ♘d2 ♘c5 21 ♗xc5 ♖xc5 22 ♘e3±* Zagrebelny,S−Bezemer,A/Ikaros GRE 2001*)* 13...♖c8 14 h5 ♘c4 15 ♗xc4 ♖xc4 16 f3 b5 17 ♔b1 ♕c7 18 g6+− Yu Shaoteng−Zhao Jun/HeiBei CHN 2001.

8 g4 h6 9 f4 b5 10 g5 ♘fd7 11 ♘d5 ♗b7 12 ♗d2?! This looks too much like a cheapo. 12...♘c6 13 gxh6 ♗h4+ 14 ♔f1 White's king is wide open. 14...gxh6 15 c4 bxc4 16 ♗xc4 exf4 17 ♖c1 ♖c8 18 ♗e2 ♘f6 19 ♗g4 ♘xd5 20 exd5 ♘e5∓ Bologan,V−Svidler,P/Tomsk RUS 2001

8 f4 b5 9 ♗f3 ♗b7 10 fxe5 dxe5 11 ♕xd8+ ♗xd8 12 ♘c5 ♗c6 13 a4 ♗a5 14 ♗d2 ♘bd7 15 ♘xd7 ♔xd7 16 0-0-0 ♔e6 17 ♖he1 h5 18 h4 ♖hc8 19 axb5 axb5 20 ♘b1 ♗xd2+ 21 ♖xd2= Polgar,J−Van Wely,L/Wijk aan Zee NED 2000.

8 ♗g5 ♗e6 9 ♕d2 ♘bd7 10 f4 ♖c8 11 f5 ♗c4 12 ♗xc4 ♖xc4 13 ♕d3 ♕c7 14 0-0-0 b5 *(14...♖xc3!?* deserves a real long look*)* 15 ♘d2 ♖c6 16 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 17 ♘d5 ♘xd5 18 exd5 White's Ne4 vs Be7 is a mismatch. 18...♖b6 19 ♔b1 0-0 20 ♘e4± De Firmian,N−Roeder,M/Las Palmas ESP 1999.

8...0-0



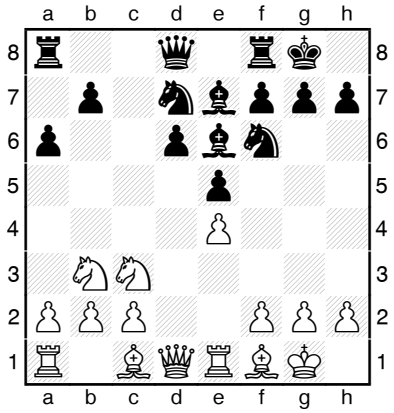
8...♗e6 9 f4 *(9 a4 ♘bd7 10 f4 ♕c7 11 ♔h1 h6 12 a5 0-0 13 f5 ♗c4 14 ♗e3 ♖fc8 15 ♗xc4 ♕xc4 16 ♕f3 ♕c7 17 ♘d2 ♕d8 18 ♖fc1 ♖c7 19 ♘d5 ♘xd5 20 exd5 ♖ac8 21 c4 ♗g5 22 b3 ♗xe3 23 ♕xe3* Black's pieces are all bottled up. *23...♘f6 24 ♘e4±* Kolev,A−Anand,V/Villarrobledo ESP 2001*)* 9...♕c7 10 ♘d5 ♗xd5 11 exd5 ♘bd7 12 c4 0-0 13 ♔h1 ♖fe8 14 ♗e3 exf4 15 ♗xf4 ♗f8 Black's control of e5 gives good play 16 ♖c1 ♕b6 17 ♖c2 g6 18 ♗f3 ♖ac8 19 ♘c1 ♘e5 20 b3 h5 21 h3 ♗g7 22 ♘e2 ♘xf3 23 gxf3 White's king is a bit airy. 23...♕c5∓ Anand,V−Kasparov,G/Linares ESP 2000

9 ♖e1

9 ♗e3 ♗e6 10 ♕d2 *(10 ♘d5 ♘bd7 11 ♕d3 ♗xd5 12 exd5 ♘c5 13 ♕d2 ♘fe4 14 ♕b4 a5 15 ♕b5 ♕c7 16 ♖fd1 b6 17 ♕c4 f5 18 ♗d3 ♕d8 19 ♘xc5 ♘xc5 20 a3 ♖c8=* Svidler,P−Polgar,J/Dos Hermanas 1999) 10...♘bd7 11 a4 ♖c8 12 a5 ♖e8 13 ♖fc1 h6 14 f3 ♗f8 15 ♘d5 ♘xd5 16 exd5 ♗f5 17 c4 ♗h7 18 ♖e1 f5 19 f4 exf4 20 ♗xf4 g5 21 ♗e3 ♘e5 22 ♖ac1 f4 23 ♗d4± Asrian,K−Naumann,A/Yerevan ARM 1999

9 ♔h1 b6 10 a4 ♗b7 11 f3 ♘c6 12 ♘d5 ♘xd5 13 exd5 ♘b4 14 c4 a5 15 ♗d2 ♘a6 16 ♗c3 ♗g5 17 ♗d3 ♗c8 18 ♕c2 g6∓ Polgar,J−Topalov,V/Dos Hermanas 1999

9...♗e6 10 ♗f1 ♘bd7



11 ♘d5

The Canadian GM has gotten good results with this idea.

11...♘xd5 12 exd5 ♗f5 13 a4 ♖c8 14 c3 ♗g5

14...♗g6 15 a5 f5 16 f4 ♗f6 17 ♖a4 ♘c5 18 ♖b4 ♘xb3 19 ♖xb3 ♕d7 20 ♗e3 ♖fe8 21 ♕d2 exf4 22 ♗xf4 ♖xe1 23 ♕xe1 ♖e8 24 ♕d2 ♗e5 25 ♖b6 ♕c7 26 ♗xe5 ♖xe5 27 c4± Spraggett,K−Gallagher,J/Bordeaux FRA 2001

15 ♗xg5 ♕xg5 16 a5 ♗g6 17 ♖a4

17 ♘d2 f5 18 ♘c4 ♖f6 19 ♖a4 ♘c5 20 ♖b4 f4 21 ♖b6 ♖d8 22 b4+− Spraggett,K−Zagrebelny,S/Istanbul TUR 2000

17...f5 18 ♖b4 ♖c7 19 f4 exf4 20 ♕d2?! (20 ♘d4! looks strong)

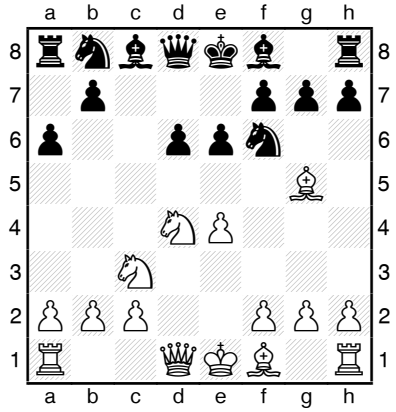
20...♗f7 21 ♖xf4 ♘e5 22 g3 ♖e7 23 ♗g2 ♖fe8 24 ♖ef1 ♘g4 25 ♗f3 ♘e3∓

Spraggett,K−Fressinet,L/Bordeaux FRA 2001.

6 Bg5 miscellaneous part 2 [B95]

Last updated: 06/04/02 by Fed

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5 e6



7 ♕f3

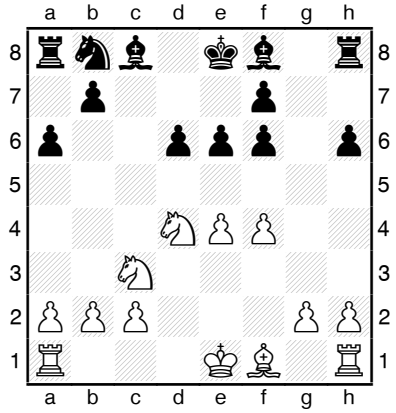
7 ♕d3 ♘bd7 8 0-0-0 b5 9 f4 b4 10 ♘ce2 ♕a5 11 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 12 e5 ♘d5 13 ♔b1 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♗b7 15 ♘g3 0-0-0 16 ♗e2 ♕b6 17 ♖hf1 ♘c3+!-+ Kovalev,A–Bologan,V/Minsk BLR 2000

7 ♗d3 The Najdorf is one opening where something innocuous meets with a terrible fate. 7...♗e7 8 f4 0-0 9 ♕f3 ♘bd7 10 0-0-0 ♕c7 11 ♕h3 ♘c5 12 g4 b5 13 a3 ♗b7 14 ♕f3 ♖ab8 15 ♘de2 ♗a8 16 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 17 g5 ♗xc3 18 ♘xc3 b4 19 axb4 ♖xb4∓ With good action on the b and c files. 20 ♘a2 ♘xd3+ 21 ♖xd3 ♗xe4 22 ♖c3 ♕b7 Ssegirinya,J–Nguyen Anh Dung/Shenyang CHN 1999.

7...h6

7...♘bd7 8 0-0-0 ♗e7 *(8...h6!?)* 9 ♕h3 *(9 ♗e2 ♕c7 10 ♕g3 b5 11 ♗xb5 axb5 12 ♘dxb5 ♕b8 13 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 14 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 15 ♖xd6 h6 16 ♗xf6 gxf6 17 b3 ♖g8 18 g3 h5* White's passed pawns aren't worth a piece here. *19 h4 ♗b7 20 ♖e1 0-0-0 21 ♖e3 ♘e5 22 ♖xd8+ ♖xd8 23 a4 ♘g4 24 ♖e2 ♗a6 25 ♘b5 ♔b7 26 f3 ♘e5 27 ♖e3 ♗xb5 28 axb5 ♔b6∓* Kwatschewsky,L–Wach,M/Vienna AUT 1999 The pawns start dropping.*)* 9...♕c7 10 ♗d3 b5 11 f4 b4 12 ♘ce2 ♘c5 13 ♘g3 h6 14 ♖he1 e5 15 ♘df5 g6 16 ♕h4 ♗xf5 17 exf5 ♘xd3+ 18 ♖xd3 ♖c8 19 ♖e2 hxg5 20 ♕xh8+ ♔d7 21 ♕h3 g4 22 ♕h6 ♕c4 23 fxe5 ♕xd3 24 exf6 ♗xf6 25 ♖d2 ♕c4-+ Thorhallsson,T–Leitao,R/New York USA 2000

8 ♗xf6 ♕xf6 9 ♕xf6 gxf6 10 f4



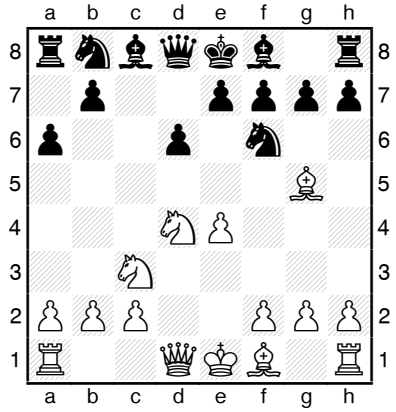
10...h5 11 f5 ♘c6 12 ♖d1 ♗d7 13 ♗c4 ♔e7 14 ♗b3 ♗h6 15 ♖f1 ♘xd4 16 ♖xd4 ♖ag8 17 g3 ♗c1 18 ♘e2 ♗xb2 19 ♖b4 ♗c6 20 ♗xe6 fxe6 21 ♖xb2 e5 22 ♘c3 h4 23 ♖f3 ♔f7 24 ♖d3 hxg3 25 hxg3 ♖h2 26 ♔f1 ♔e7∓

1/2-1/2 Short,N−Kasparov,G/Sarajevo BIH 2000.

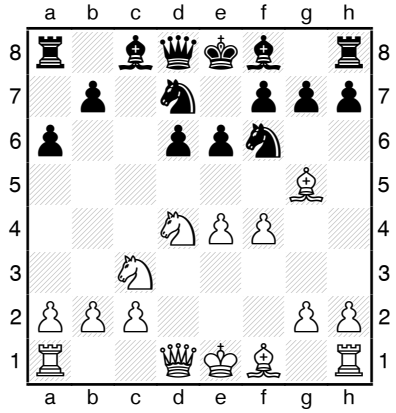
Najdorf 6 Bg5 miscellaneous [B96]

Last updated: 06/04/02 by Fed

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5



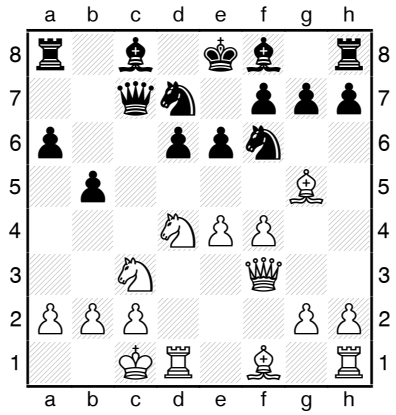
6...e6 7 f4 ♘bd7



7...♘c6!? A decent alternative that avoids the serious theory. 8 ♕d2 h6 9 ♗xf6 ♕xf6 10 ♘f3 ♕d8 *(10...g5!* Fighting for the dark squares is best.*)* 11 h4 ♗e7 12 0-0-0 b5 13 ♔b1 ♕a5 14 g4 ♗b7 15 ♖h3 0-0-0 16 ♕e1 ♔b8 17 g5 hxg5 18 hxg5 ♖xh3 19 ♗xh3 g6 20 ♕e3 b4 21 ♘d5 exd5 22 exd5 b3 23 dxc6 ♕xa2+ 24 ♔c1 ♗xc6 25 ♘d4 ♕a1+ 26 ♔d2 ♕a4 27 cxb3 ♕b4+ 28 ♔c1 ♗d7 29 ♗xd7 ♕c5+ 30 ♔b1 ♖xd7 31 ♖c1± Murey,J−Saravanan,V/London ENG 1999

7...b5?! Somewhere along the line the Polugaevsky variation fell out of favor. If anything it's over−sharp. 8 ♗d3 Too deliberate. *(8 e5!* White feels the need to punish Black for the premature ...b5. *8...dxe5 9 fxe5 ♕c7 10 exf6 ♕e5+ 11 ♗e2 ♕xg5 12 0-0 ♖a7 13 ♕d3 ♖d7 14 ♘e4 ♕e5 15 ♘f3 ♕f4 16 ♕c3 ♕xe4 17 fxg7 ♗xg7 18 ♕xg7 ♖f8 19 ♗d3 ♕e3+ 20 ♔h1 f6 21 ♕g4 ♖e7 22 a4!*± Stanford,M−North,R/Vancouver BC CAN 2001*)* 8...♕c7 9 ♘ce2?! This shouldn't lead to anything. 9...♗e7 10 ♕d2 ♗b7 *(10...♘bd7!?* Black is fine*)* 11 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 12 0-0-0 ♘d7 13 ♗xb5 ♗xe4 14 ♗xd7+ ♕xd7 15 ♘g3 ♗d5 16 ♘h5 ♕d8 17 ♘f5 0-0 18 ♘e3 ♖b8 19 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 20 ♕d4 ♕h6 21 ♘xd5 exd5 22 ♖d3± Galiana,J−Angel Acosta,J/Cala Galdana ESP 1999.

8 ♕f3 ♕c7 9 0-0-0 b5



10 a3

10 e5 ♗b7 11 ♕h3 dxe5 12 ♘xe6 This is just an exciting way to make a draw. 12...fxe6 13 ♕xe6+ ♗e7 14 ♗xb5 axb5 15 ♘xb5 ♕c6 16 ♘d6+ ♔d8 17 fxe5 ♔c7 18 ♕xe7 ♖xa2 19 exf6 ♖a1+ 20 ♔d2 ♕d5+ Nisipeanu,L−Shirov,A/Las Vegas USA 1999 With a perpet.

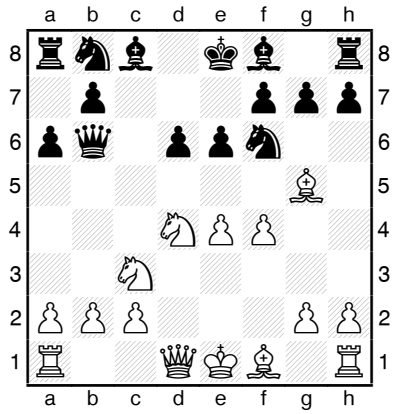
10...♗b7 11 g4 ♗e7 12 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 13 g5 ♘d7 14 ♗h3 ♘c5 15 ♖hg1 g6 16 ♔b1 ♕b6 17 ♕e3 b4 18 axb4 ♕xb4 19 f5 ♖b8 20 ♘a2 ♕c4 21 fxe6 fxe6 22 ♕c3 ♕xc3 23 ♘xc3 ♗c8 24 e5 dxe5 25 ♘c6 ♖b6 26 ♘xe5 0-0 27 ♘d3 ♖f3 28 ♗g4 ♘xd3 29 ♖xd3 ♖xd3 30 cxd3 ♗xg5 31 ♗xe6+ ♖xe6 32 ♖xg5=

Leko,P−Shirov,A/Monaco MNC 2001.

Poisoned Pawn Najdorf [B97]

Last updated: 06/04/02 by Fed

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 ♕b6



The Poisoned Pawn variation is one of the sharpest replies to 6 Bg5. It's been played by both Fischer and Kasparov with great success.

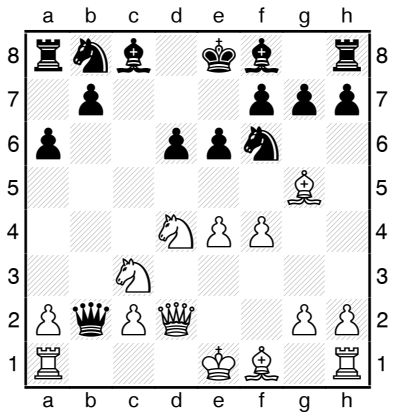
8 ♕d2

8 ♘b3!? If I was given a choice I'd try Nb3, but Black is ok.

a) 8...♘bd7 9 ♗e2 ♗e7 10 ♕d2 h6 *(10...♕c7!?)* 11 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 12 0-0-0 ♕c7 13 ♗f3 ♖b8 14 ♔b1 ♘d7?! *(14...b5* looks ok*)* 15 h4 b5 16 g4 b4 17 ♘e2 e5 18 ♘g3 g6 19 f5± Vuckovic,B−Colovic,A/Lazarevac YUG 1999

b) 8...♗e7 9 ♕f3 ♘bd7 10 0-0-0 ♕c7 11 ♗d3 b5 *(11...h6 12 ♗h4 g5 13 ♗f2 gxf4 14 ♕xf4 b5 15 ♔b1 b4 16 ♘e2 ♗b7 17 ♖hf1 ♘e5* The strong Ne5 exerts pressure on White's position. *18 h3 h5∓* Leko,P−Anand,V/Leon ESP 2001*)* 12 a3 ♖b8 13 ♖he1 b4 14 axb4 ♖xb4 15 ♔b1 ♗b7 16 ♕h3 ♘c5 17 ♘xc5 dxc5 18 e5 ♘d5 19 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 20 c3 ♖b3 21 ♗c2± Leko,P−Kasparov,G/Linares ESP 2001 Black's king could become a problem.

8...♕xb2



8...♘c6!? Black chickens out but gets into something that resembles a Rauser. 9 ♗xf6 gxf6 10 ♘b3 ♗d7 11 0-0-0 0-0-0 12 ♗e2 h5 13 ♔b1 ♔b8 14 ♖hf1 ♗e7 15 ♖f3 ♖c8 16 ♖h3 ♘a5 17 ♗xh5± Kersten,U−Gutman,L/Altenkirchen GER 1999

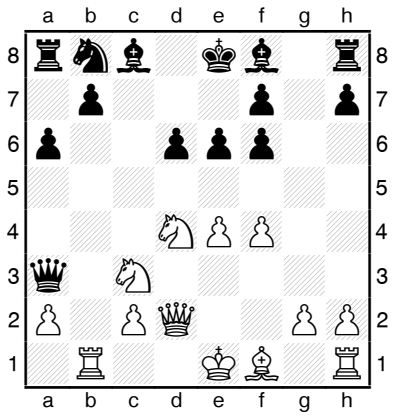
9 ♖b1

9 ♘b3!? From what I've seen this might be White's best course of action. 9...♘c6 10 ♗xf6 gxf6 11 ♘a4 ♕a3 12 ♘b6 ♖b8 13 ♘c4 ♕a4 14 a3 b5 15 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 16 ♕xd6 ♕xe4+ 17 ♗e2 ♕d5 18 ♕xd5 exd5 19 0-0-0 ♗e6 20 g4 f5 21 ♖he1 ♘e7 22 ♗d3± Rogers,I−Van der Sterren,P/Hertogenbosch NED 1999 White has ideas like Nc5 or Nd4 coming up.

9...♕a3 10 ♗xf6

10 ♗e2 ♗e7 11 0-0 ♘c6 12 ♘xc6 bxc6 13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♕c5+ 15 ♔h1 ♕xe5 16 ♗f4 ♕c5 17 ♘a4 ♕a7 18 ♘b6 0-0 19 ♘xa8 ♕xa8 20 ♖b3 ♕a7 21 ♗e3 c5= Salov,S−De Firmian,N/Hamburg GER 1999, Black has 2 pawns for the exchange and a solid position.

10...gxf6



11 ♗e2 h5

11...♘c6 12 ♘xc6 bxc6 13 0-0 ♕a5 14 ♔h1 ♗e7 15 ♖b3 h5 16 ♗f3 ♔f8 17 ♕e2 ♖a7 18 ♖fb1 ♖c7 19 ♕e3 h4∓ Stripunsky,A−De Firmian,N /Chicago 2000, in addition to being up a pawn Black has the bishop pair and a central pawn wall.

12 0-0 ♘d7 13 ♗f3 ♘c5 14 e5 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♗h6 16 ♕e1 f5 17 ♔h1 ♗d7 18 ♗xh5 ♗g7 19 ♗f3 ♖c8 20 ♘d1 b5∓

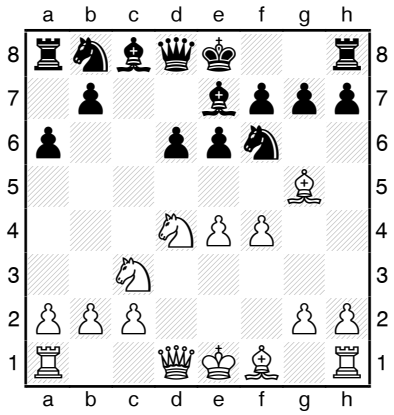
Hracek,Z−Georgiev,K/Batumi GEO 1999 Black's position makes a lot more sense than White's.

Najdorf − old main line with g4 [B99]

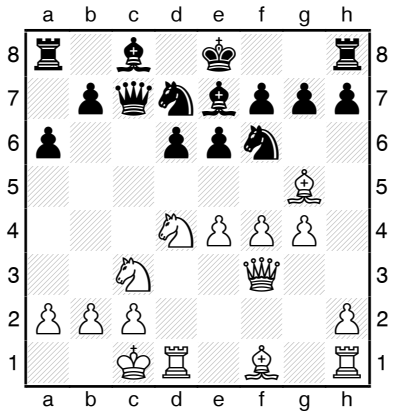
Last updated: 06/04/02 by Fed

This variation from Black's point of view is very reasonable. It seems to have gotten lost in the "Poison Pawn" shuffle, but is a good choice vs 6 Bg5.

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 ♗e7



8 ♕f3 ♕c7 9 0-0-0 ♘bd7 10 g4



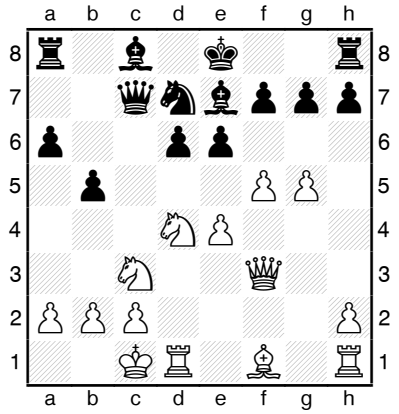
10...b5

This line was played a lot in the mid−eighties with Black getting decent results.

11 ♗xf6 ♘xf6

11...gxf6!? This sharper recapture was a Fischer favorite. 12 ♗d3 ♗b7 *(12...♘b6* is advised*)* 13 ♔b1 0-0-0 14 h4 ♔b8 15 g5 f5 16 ♕h5!± Black needs active counterplay after gf6.

12 g5 ♘d7 13 f5



13 ♔b1 b4 14 ♘ce2 ♗b7 15 ♗h3 ♘c5 16 ♘g3 d5 17 f5 dxe4 18 ♕h5 g6 19 fxg6 fxg6 20 ♕g4 ♗d5 21 ♖he1 0-0 22 ♕e2 ♖f4∓ Moya Soriano,M−Moreno,J/Cala Galdana ESP 1999

13...♗xg5+!?

This was considered bad years ago, but now it gives Black good chances. White gets a Nd5 while Black gets good piece play.

13...♘c5?! This move ran into big trouble after 14 f6 gxf6 15 gxf6 Bf8 16 Rg1. An idea of the late Hungarian IM Perenyi. 14 h4 This is too slow, but Black must play actively. 14...b4 15 ♘b1 e5?! 15...Bb7! 16 ♘b3 ♘d7 17 ♘1d2 a5 18 ♔b1 a4 19 ♘c1 ♘b6 20 b3 ♗a6 21 ♗xa6 ♖xa6 22 f6 gxf6 23 gxf6± Groszpeter,A−Sammalvuo,T/Paks HUN 2001

14 ♔b1 ♘e5 15 ♕h5 ♕e7

15...♕d8 16 ♘xe6 *(16 fxe6 g6 17 exf7+ ♔xf7 18 ♕e2 ♗g4 19 ♕f2+ ♕f6 20 ♕xf6+ ♗xf6 21 ♗e2 ♗xe2 22 ♘dxe2 ♘c4∓* Ramirez Allo,E−Roeder,M/Las Palmas ESP 1999*)* 16...♗xe6 17 fxe6 0-0 18 ♖g1 ♗f6 19 ♗h3 ♔h8 20 ♘d5 g6 21 ♕e2 fxe6 22 ♗xe6 ♗g7∓ Rajlich,V−Peng Zhaoqin/Budapest HUN 2001 In the bishop of opposites middlegame Black's is superior.

16 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 17 fxe6 g6 18 exf7+ ♔xf7 19 ♕h3

19 ♕e2 ♔g7 20 ♘d5 ♕a7 21 h4 ♗h6 22 h5 ♖af8 Mendoza,R−Bruzon,L/Cali COL 2001
With good dark square play.

19...♔g7 20 ♘d5 ♕d8 21 ♗e2 ♖f8 22 ♖hf1 ♖xf1 23 ♖xf1 ♖b8 24 ♕e6 ♕d7 25 ♕xd7+ ♘xd7 26 ♗d3 ♖b7 27 b4 ♘f6∓

Rudolf,H−Najer,E/Polanica Zdroj POL 1999.